

1.5 The Thirty-Minute Diagnostic Sprint

Complete all three exercises below in a single session. Total time: thirty minutes. You will produce three artifacts: a Voice Bleed Audit, a Voice Benchmark, and a Failed-Approach Autopsy.

1.5.1 Setup Checklist

Confirm you have everything before starting the timer.

- ☐ One AI-generated dialogue sample from your current WIP (a scene with at least two speaking characters)
- ☐ A pen and notebook, or a blank document open on screen
- ☐ A timer set for thirty minutes
- ☐ Permission to be honest about what you see, without flinching or self-blame

1.5.2 Exercise 1: Five-Dimensional Voice Bleed Audit

Instructions: Select one AI-generated dialogue scene. For each speaking character, fill in the table below. Write one sentence describing what the AI produced and one sentence describing what the character should sound like. Rate the severity of the gap.

Character name: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Scene reference: [CHAPTER_OR_SCENE_DESCRIPTION]

Dimension	What the AI Produced (one sentence)	What This Character Should Sound Like (one sentence)	Severity
Cadence	[YOUR_OBSERVATION]	[YOUR_TARGET]	Mild / Moderate / Severe
Vocabulary Range	[YOUR_OBSERVATION]	[YOUR_TARGET]	Mild / Moderate / Severe
Sentence-Length Variance	[YOUR_OBSERVATION]	[YOUR_TARGET]	Mild / Moderate / Severe
Emotional Register	[YOUR_OBSERVATION]	[YOUR_TARGET]	Mild / Moderate / Severe

Dimension	What the AI Produced (one sentence)	What This Character Should Sound Like (one sentence)	Severity
Conversational Rhythm	[YOUR_OBSERVATION]	[YOUR_TARGET]	Mild / Moderate / Severe

Repeat for each speaking character in the scene.

Post-Audit Questions:

- Which dimensions show up as "Severe" most often? [YOUR_ANSWER]
- Which character suffers the most flattening? [YOUR_ANSWER]
- What single dimension, if corrected first, would produce the largest audible shift? [YOUR_ANSWER]

1.5.3 Exercise 2: Voice Benchmark Template

Instructions: Write three to four lines of dialogue for your most voice-distinct character by hand. Write them the way the character speaks in your head when nobody is watching. Then paste the AI-generated version of the same moment beside it. Run the five-dimensional lens on both.

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]
Scene context: [BRIEF_SITUATION]

My handwritten version (the gold standard):

[WRITE_3_TO_4_LINES_OF_DIALOGUE_EXACTLY_AS_THIS_CHARACTER_WOULD_SPEAK]

AI-generated version (for comparison):

[PASTE_AI_OUTPUT_FOR_THE_SAME_MOMENT]

Dimension-by-dimension comparison:

Dimension	My Handwritten Version	AI Version	Gap Summary (one phrase)
Cadence	[DESCRIBE]	[DESCRIBE]	[E.G., "AI smooths all fragments into full sentences"]
Vocabulary Range	[DESCRIBE]	[DESCRIBE]	[ONE_PHRASE]

Dimension	My Handwritten Version	AI Version	Gap Summary (one phrase)
Sentence-Length Variance	[DESCRIBE]	[DESCRIBE]	[ONE_PHRASE]
Emotional Register	[DESCRIBE]	[DESCRIBE]	[ONE_PHRASE]
Conversational Rhythm	[DESCRIBE]	[DESCRIBE]	[ONE_PHRASE]

Action: Pin this completed template above your desk or save it as a permanent reference file. Every future AI output for this character gets measured against this benchmark.

1.5.4 Exercise 3: Failed-Approach Autopsy Log

Instructions: Think back to the last three times you tried to fix voice bleed. For each attempt, identify the approach used, the dimensions it actually targeted, and the dimensions it left untouched.

Attempt #	Scene / Date	Approach Used	Dimensions Targeted	Dimensions Left Untouched
1	[SCENE_AND_DATE]	Vague re-prompt / Manual rewrite / Style-mimicry / AI abandonment	[E.G., "Emotional Register only"]	[E.G., "Character Sentence-length Conversational Rhythm"]
2	[SCENE_AND_DATE]	[APPROACH]	[DIMENSIONS_TARGETED]	[DIMENSIONS_LEFT_UNTOUCHED]
3	[SCENE_AND_DATE]	[APPROACH]	[DIMENSIONS_TARGETED]	[DIMENSIONS_LEFT_UNTOUCHED]

Post-Autopsy Reflection: Count the entries in the "Dimensions Left Untouched" column. In most cases you will see four dimensions sitting idle while you poured energy into one. That is the structural reason the output never improved. Write the total number of untouched dimensions across all three attempts here: [YOUR_COUNT]